

## fish dream

before i was lost, i felt more

like a fish. with a friend—

Nya. we go on swims,

three laps around the glob of coral near home. well, it used to be coral. now it's the color of unripe cantaloupe.

anyways, water hazy, we talk. and when she asks what i am most longing, i say the surface,

to reflect, on the question,  
of the question, of how i got here.

and then i realized—Nya wasn't the type to ask me about myself. so who was probing my surface?

it was me. Nya gone, navy water, i had been in deep conversation with myself.

and when i looked up, i didn't see the coral—  
or cantaloupe. no longer recognizing my surroundings,

i was lost. no memory of when Nya disappeared, or how long, i had been wandering into the abyss.

and so i searched, for home, rain pouring down, water on water, only a glint of light through the storm. and when

i saw the coral, peaking out high up over the ridge, the supposed sight of my relief.

i felt more lost than before.